



Microsoft hits a milestone

Microsoft Research team's speech recognition has a "word error rate" of 5.9 percent, on par with professional human transcribers. <http://dgit.in/MSSpChRcg>



Big brother is watching

Oyoty is an AI-powered bot that acts as a big brother to teach kids to be safe online by linking to their social media accounts.



The Lumia ad was quite funny!

get a good shot. What ensues is total chaos and pandemonium as iPhone and Samsung Galaxy wielding parents battle for a better perspective. In the end, a couple are shown calmly sitting at the back. The lady asks the husband why they aren't going forward, to which he replies while showing the highly detailed shots he's already taken, 'With the Lumia 1020, we've got the best seats on the house'. While the Lumia line didn't exactly make a big dent in the long run, this ad did take a good shot at all its competitors. (Watch: <http://dgit.in/Lum1020ad>)

Elon Musk vs Jeff Bezos

Elon Musk had rocket dreams since he was a child. And one of his current rivals is Jeff Bezos who recently set his sights skywards. In the past, the two companies (SpaceX and Blue Origin) had fought over launch pad 39 at NASA's Kennedy Space Centre and patents for rocket landings in the sea. SpaceX's efforts to land an aircraft upright were yet to bear fruition when Jeff Bezos' aircraft manufacturing and spaceflight company Blue Origin struck gold. On November 23rd 2015 when their rocket ship the New Shepard made it to space and landed upright upon its return to Earth, Bezos took the opportunity to make his first tweet about the achievement. Although Elon Musk was one of the first people to congratulate him (<http://dgit.in/MskTwtOne>), he followed up in his own snarky way clarifying that "space" and "orbit" are quite different (<http://dgit.in/MskTwtTwo>). He also followed up with another tweet that highlighted how SpaceX's Grasshopper had already

achieved this feat six times, as can be seen here: <http://dgit.in/MskTwtThree>.

Pretty soon, in December, when SpaceX's Falcon 9's first stage was landed, Bezos fired back with his "welcome to the club" tweet (<http://dgit.in/BzsTwtOne>), which, as you can probably understand, irked a lot of Musk

fans and followers. That is because the Falcon 9 went much further than New Shepard did. Bezos soon found a way to make truce over Twitter again when



The real world Tony Stark, Elon Musk didn't take Jeff Bezos' claim too well

he unequivocally congratulated SpaceX on their landing a used rocket booster on a drone ship in the Pacific ocean in this tweet: <http://dgit.in/BzsTwtTwo>.

Flipkart vs Snapdeal

The Indian e-commerce space is highly competitive. It is not uncommon to see the big e-commerce players in the country host discounts and sales to outsell each other - literally and metaphorically. The same sentiment sometimes carries forwards to their marketing campaigns.

In 2015, Flipkart was heavily pushing its campaign #AcchaKiya, both online and offline, telling people that their

non-purchase of products offline was a good decision. To counter this campaign, Snapdeal launched its own 'Accha kiya bata dia #YahanSeKharido' campaign. This was obviously a dig at Flipkart's own slogan, asking users to move to Snapdeal for their shopping needs.

It was not limited to the online sphere. Reportedly, on multiple locations, Snapdeal's #YahanSeKharido billboards were strategically placed under Flipkart's #AcchaKiya billboards. Needless to the say, users and the online audience loved this back and forth and actually took it forward in photoshopped images too. If only Amazon had anything to say in this!

Samsung India vs Micromax

Back when the Samsung Galaxy Y was Samsung's budget offering, Samsung ran a TVC in India where a middle aged man is shown deriding a few young people for making noise while he was having trouble getting some work done using two separate phones. The next scene showed the youngster brandishing the new Samsung Galaxy Y highlighting the fact that the phone had dual SIM capability. (Watch: <http://dgit.in/SmsngY>)

This ad series was followed up by Micromax with its own series of ads, which started with the same dialogue that the Samsung ads ended with (*Aapke paas nahi hai, uncle?*). This one goes a bit different though. A couple of other youngsters are shown to call the girl out on her smartphone and actu-



The two e-commerce giants do keep taking pot shots at each other when it comes to advertising